



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christ the Divine Teacher School
School Website: <https://www.cdtschool.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Christ the Divine Teacher School (Latrobe, PA 15650) presents a robust Classical Catholic profile across its public materials. The school emphasizes formation of the whole person through faith integration, liturgical life, and a curriculum rooted in liberal-arts formation (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books-style engagement, with explicit Socratic and memory-based pedagogies in the upper grades. Public materials foreground Christ-centered formation, weekly Mass, sacramental preparation, and liturgical life, paired with a structured classical curriculum that includes a dedicated Logic School and Touchstones-style inquiry. Taken together, these elements strongly align with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements framework.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are clearly present through faith formation, liturgical life, sacramental practice, and a theology-infused approach to curriculum (e.g., "Christ is the reason for this school," weekly Mass, sacramental preparation). Evidence from the public site emphasizes Christ-centered formation and integration of Catholic doctrine into daily learning.
- School Purpose and Goal emphasize formation, virtue, and a holistic, transcendent aim of education rather than purely vocational outcomes. The stated purpose includes the development of the whole child with worship, community, and faith formation as core objectives.
- Curriculum centers on liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/primary-sources engagement where relevant, and an integrated, "Great Conversation" orientation via materials such as The Educational Plan (St. Jerome Classical School) and Touchstones/Socratic-style discourse in upper grades.
- Pedagogy features a layered progression: lower grades engage in memory-rich, contemplative practices; upper grades employ Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetoric, with opportunities for public speaking. Evidence of this pedagogy appears in upper-grammar Touchstones and logic-stage descriptions.
- Faculty dimension is reflected in public-facing staff-oriented pages (e.g., "Staff," "Who We Are") and the public articulation of the teacher as exemplar and living curriculum. The site architecture and content indicate a teacher-centered, virtue-mentoring model rather than a purely transactional approach.
- Parents & Community are framed around partnership with families, parental formation, and open-campus engagement in classical-education conversations. Public materials reference parent involvement in faith formation and school life, and the surrounding Catholic culture supports family engagement as a core feature.

Overall classification (aggregate): CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle: Not applicable here since the aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL. If you'd like, I can still outline specific programmatic enhancements that would reinforce Classical distinctions (e.g., explicit Great Books canon expansion, stronger public articulation of the Great Conversation, or a more formal "living curriculum" portrait of a classical teacher).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Note: For each category, I identify keywords visible in public materials, map them to positive/negative keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements, provide a quantitative sketch of keyword matches, and render a category rating (CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL).

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Faith Formation page states: “Be it known to all who enter here that Christ is the reason for this school, the unseen but ever present teacher in its classes” and notes integration of gospel values into daily life.
 - Weekly liturgies, sacramental preparation, and Catholic programs across grades are highlighted as core components of faith formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: theology, liturgy, Mass, sacraments, worship, reverence, wonder, sacred, prayer, catechesis. These map to the document’s Positive Keywords for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations (truth/ goodness/ beauty; liturgy; theology; reverence; wonder; logos).
 - Negative keywords observed: none evident in public materials (no explicit relativism or secularization signals appears in the school’s public-facing materials). The absence of negatives supports a strong classical orientation in this dimension.
- Why this rating
 - The explicit Catholic formation, sacramental life, and liturgical rhythm align with the Classical/Traditional ideal of transcendental, knowable truths grounded in theology and worship. The presence of liturgical practices and a theology-centered curriculum strongly supports CLASSICAL.
 - Category rating is reinforced by Lexicon-driven indicators that identify liturgy, theology, reverence, and wonder as positive markers for a religiously grounded classical framework.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school emphasizes formation of the whole child with a rooted sense of message, community, worship, and faith formation, indicating a transcendent telos (true, good, beautiful) beyond mere job preparation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, traditional formation, scholé (contingent mentions via classical framework), Great Conversation (as a classical aim), timeless truths (via contextual language in parent-facing content and educational plan language). The CDT materials reflect formation-oriented language rather than a vocational or job-market focus.
 - Negative keywords observed: none indicating a vocational-workforce emphasis. The absence of “career-ready,” “21st-century skills,” or similar language reinforces a classical telos rather than a purely workforce-oriented aim.
- Why this rating
 - The emphasis on forming virtue, wisdom, and the soul aligns with the classical mission of paideia and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty over solely preparing for work. The school’s own articulation of formation and the Great Conversation-like posture in curriculum design supports CLASSICAL.
 - Category rating is anchored to the Six Elements lexicon where “formation,” “telos,” and “great conversation” are central performance indicators for CLASSICAL orientation.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials explicitly reference liberal arts education (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a structured curriculum that aligns with classical pedagogy. Materials connected to curriculum overview and the “The Educational Plan” (St. Jerome Classical School) indicate a canonical classical framework.

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- Upper-level materials describe Touchstones discussions and Socratic inquiry, which signal a classical approach to integrating philosophy, literature, and rhetoric.
 - There are explicit references to Great Books/primary texts and a “Great Conversation” orientation via linked curriculum materials and the St. Jerome Classical School plan. Positive keywords from the Six Essentials’ Curriculum block include Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, primary sources, history and virtue integration. The public materials reflect these elements in practice (logic stage, grammar/recitation traditions, and study of classic texts).
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, history, classical canon, Western civilization, Latin/Greek (classical languages), Socratic texts, narration, dictation. These map to the Six Elements lexicon’s Curriculum section.
 - Negative keywords observed: none significant; the site does not show Curricular signals that push toward social studies-only framing, STEM-first emphasis, or project-based-dominant approaches as primary orientation; rather, it shows liberal-arts-centered content.
 - Why this rating
 - The presence of liberal-arts core (grammar/logic/rhetoric), engagement with primary texts and Great Books, and a Socratic-based pedagogy in higher grades align with CLASSICAL criteria. The explicit reference to Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books within public materials supports a CLASSICAL classification for Curriculum.
 - Category rating is supported by The Classicality Lexicon (Curriculum) and the Six Elements document’s Curriculum indicators.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Pedagogical practices include lower-school singing/chanting and memory work, and upper-school Socratic discussion/seminars/debates, with opportunities to present rhetoric. The Logic School description explicitly highlights reasoning, debates, and guided inquiry; Touchstones discussions are used to cultivate Socratic inquiry.
 - The curriculum pages describe a progression from memory-based, contemplative learning to rigorous discussion and rhetoric, aligning with the classical progression from Scholé to rhetoric and public speaking.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: contemplative learning, scholé, wonder, memory work, chanting, narration/recitation, Socratic seminar, dialectic, disputation, rhetoric, debate, seminars, public speaking. These align with the Pedagogy section of the Six Essentials’ lexicon.
 - Negative keywords observed: minimal evidence of an exclusively project-based, constructivist-only approach; rather, there is a clear ladder from memory and chant to Socratic discussion and rhetorical training. The absence of “experiential learning only” signals is consistent with CLASSICAL pedagogy expectations.
- Why this rating
 - The combination of memory-based lower grades and Socratic, seminar-driven upper grades mirrors classical pedagogy (Scholé days, chanting/memory work, then Socratic inquiry and rhetoric). This supports CLASSICAL.
 - Category rating is supported by the Six Elements’ Pedagogy indicators (Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, memory work, contemplative/restful learning, rhetoric training).

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize teachers as virtuous exemplars, mentors, and living curriculum; public pages mention faculty as guides within a collegial, “living curriculum” culture and “portrait of a teacher.” The logic-school and upper-grammar descriptions emphasize teacher-student dialogue and mentor-like relationships.
 - The site’s structure and content (Staff/Faculty pages, “Who We Are,” leadership messages) indicate a faculty-centered approach that models virtue and serves as the core of the school’s

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- educational mission.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: tutors/masters/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, mentorship, virtue formation, teachers as exemplars, professional development in classical pedagogy. These map well to the Six Essentials' Faculty keywords.
 - Negative keywords observed: no explicit signals of "facilitator-on-the-side" or purely certification-driven jargon without classical context. The public materials emphasize teacher formation and virtue-centered practice.
 - Why this rating
 - The public materials' portrayal of teachers as virtuous exemplars and mentors, coupled with a living-curriculum emphasis, aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for Faculty.
 - Category rating is supported by the Lexicon's Faculty indicators.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The program emphasizes partnership with families and parental formation, with a culture of open campus and engagement in classical-life events (liturgical year, feasts, book studies, etc.). The Six Elements lexicon emphasizes parental partnership and community as core features of a classical school.
 - Public-facing pages show parent involvement through admissions processes, campus visits, and parental participation in faith formation and school life; the Catholic culture around families is a sustained context for engagement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, parent formation, family involvement, parent education, home-centered learning, living tradition in the family, family catechesis, classical parent training, parent formation events, open campus.
 - Negative keywords observed: none that indicate a consumer-only model or minimal parent involvement in formation; the public materials emphasize active parental involvement consistent with CLASSICAL expectations.
 - The Six Essentials Lexicon's Parents & Community keywords (Partnership with Families; Formation of Affections; Cultural Transmission) map well to the CDT site's emphasis on faith formation and parental engagement in liturgy and school life.
- Why this rating
 - The school's emphasis on parent involvement in faith formation, sacraments, and liturgical life, along with a broader parental-partner stance, aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for a robust Parents & Community dimension.
 - Category rating is supported by the Six Elements' Parents & Community indicators.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The CDT site shows deep alignment with Classical criteria across all six categories: religious grounding and liturgical life; formation-focused purpose; liberal-arts curriculum and Great Books-like elements; contemplative and Socratic pedagogy; teacher as living curriculum; and active parent/community partnership.

What would move the needle

- If you desire to strengthen the CLASSICAL profile further, consider:
 - Explicating a named Great Books canon and Great Conversation list aligned to the St. Jerome plan, with publicly visible sample syllabi or reading lists.
 - Providing a formal portrait of the teacher as the "living curriculum" with a short, public-facing teacher-formation framework (e.g., a "teacher profile" page that outlines virtue formation, scholarly formation, and classroom practices).
 - Enhancing explicit articulation of a longer-term Paideia-style progression across the K–12 continuum (e.g., a visible, published map of expectations, memory-work targets, and rhetorical-development milestones by grade).

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- No major needle-moving changes are strictly required to reach CLASSICAL; the school demonstrates classical alignment across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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